

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 14, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m89-3ma9-lxgm
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-1391

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Name: Shauna Williams

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General Comment

The plan developers must seek substantial, ongoing input from the disabled community - particularly those who use or could benefit from assistive technology, disability advocates, higher education assistive technology professionals (such as Alternative Media Specialists), and experts in creating accessible technology. Incorporating input from public comments from people of these fields is helpful, but is not enough. It is necessary to invite people from the groups referenced above as members of the plan development team, in order to ensure the plan does not unintentionally exclude or discriminate against the disabled community. Some recommendations for where to solicit qualified individuals to join the team:

- (1) The Disabled Students Programs and Services (DSPS) offices of State Chancellor's Offices for community colleges and universities.
- (2) AHEAD - Association on Higher Education and Disability.
- (3) State-level higher education/disability organizations such as CAPED - California Association for Postsecondary Education and Disability.
- (4) National-level organizations for specific disabilities, such as NAD - National Association of the Deaf; ABF - American Foundation for the Blind; LDA - Learning Disabilities Association of America; NCLD - National Center for Learning Disabilities; NAMI - National Alliance on Mental Illness; etc.